FX DEEP DIVE

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Review the 11 FX from class notes. Listen to examples. Students choose their source.	Slides 1–6: hook (dry, then mixed), what effects do, the seven classes, steps 1 and 2, why each effect needs a reason. Hand out the project sheet, the FX notes and the Source log.	Slides 1–6	p. 13, p. 14, p. 17, p. 18, p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 2	**Classes 2–5:** Core working days — apply FX, EQ all tracks, set panning.	Slides 7–11: the live EQ demo on a soloed track, pan the band, reverb and delay on a send, compression by the numbers. Then work time; circulate.	Slides 7–11	p. 15, p. 16
CLASS 3		Slide 12: EQ and pan every track. Then work time.	Slide 12	—
CLASS 4		Slide 13: add effects with a reason and A/B each one. Then work time.	Slide 13	—
CLASS 5		Full working day: refine the mix. Ask each student to bypass one effect and tell you what changed.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final adjustments, bounce. Prepare presentations and write 3 Padlet feedback questions.	Slides 14–16: refine and bounce, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their three questions.	Slides 14–16	p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 17–18: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions.	Slides 17–18	p. 22

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 2

From my common struggles: do the EQ demo early, with dramatic cuts and boosts on a soloed track. Slide 8 is that demo, and the EQ guide (page 10) is your script.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 12 and 13 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: why is that effect there, and what happens when you bypass it? For my mix critique day, use the end of Class 5 or Class 6 to play two or three volunteer mixes on the main speakers.

PREVIEW

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FX DEEP DIVE

Track map

STUDENT

Classes 2–5

Name _____ Date _____

One row per track. Every track in your mix must be EQ'd and panned thoughtfully. Tick the boxes when it is done, and write down what you did and why.

TRACK	EQ'D	EQ: WHERE, BOOST OR CUT, WHY	PANNED	PAN (L / C / R)	EFFECTS ON IT
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		
	☐		☐		

MIX CHECK (STEP 5) ·

- ☐ Listened on headphones
- ☐ Listened on speakers, or on a different pair of headphones
- ☐ Left and right feel balanced
- ☐ I can hear every important part
- ☐ I bypassed each effect once to check it helps

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FX DEEP DIVE

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose your source: remix your own previous project OR pick a multitrack from Cambridge-MT
- ☐ Use at least 5 different FX from the 11 covered in your class notes
- ☐ Every track in your mix must be EQ'd and panned thoughtfully
- ☐ FX choices should be stylistically appropriate for the genre
- ☐ Your final mix should demonstrate clarity, depth, and balance

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Review** — Revisit your notes on the 11 FX from the Native Instruments video (notes page: page 14)
2. **Choose your source** — Decide whether to remix your own project or download a multitrack from Cambridge-MT (log it on page 13)
3. **Plan and apply FX** — Add at least 5 different effects across your mix. Think about genre conventions. (FX log: page 16)
4. **EQ and pan every track** — Shape tone with EQ and place each instrument in the stereo field (Track map: page 15)
5. **Refine your mix** — Adjust levels, tweak FX settings, and check on headphones and speakers
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your final mix and prepare to walk the class through your FX choices
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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FX DEEP DIVE

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

FX Deep Dive | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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